



Imagine meeting a creature that looks like a spider, but isn't quite a spider! That's a camel spider for you. These fascinating creatures have two big jaws that take up almost 1/3 of their body size, and have eight legs, just like their spider buddies. But don't be scared, they're harmless to humans and aren't as big as the Internet might have you think!



So where do these interesting critters live, you ask? Camel spiders, also known as solifuges, are found in hot desert regions around the world, including the Middle East and southwestern United States. They prefer to stay hidden during the day to avoid the scorching sun and come out at night to hunt for food. Their food of choice? Insects, rodents, and sometimes even small birds!

Now, let's talk about the life cycle of our eight-legged desert friend. After a male and female camel spider pair up, the female lays her eggs in a burrow and guards them until they hatch. The tiny spiderlings then leave the nest to start life on their own, growing and shedding their skin several times before reaching adulthood. Unlike many spiders, camel spiders don't spin webs and prefer to chase down their prey instead.



Wondering how they get along with other creatures? Well, camel spiders are solitary creatures and don't interact much with other animals, except when they're hunting. Their big jaws are their main form of defense and are also used to catch and eat their prey. So in conclusion, camel spiders are unique creatures that are different from other spiders in many ways, such as not spinning webs and having a different lifestyle.



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What do camel spiders use their large jaws for?
A. Climbing trees
B. Catching and eating their prey
C. Building their nests
D. Digging burrows
- 2) Where can you find camel spiders in the United States?
A. The South East
B. The North East
C. The South West
D. The North West
- 3) Where can you find camel spiders?
A. In city areas
B. In the forest
C. In the Arctic regions
D. In hot desert regions
- 4) About how large are the camel spider's jaws?
A. Twice as large as their body
B. They don't have jaws
C. Almost a 1/3 of their body
D. The same size as their body
- 5) How many eyes does a camel spider have?
A. Six
B. Four
C. Eight
D. Seven
- 6) Are camel spiders harmful to humans?
A. Yes
B. Only males camel spiders
C. Only female camel spiders
D. No
- 7) What is another name for camel spiders?
A. Desert crabs
B. Sand spiders
C. Scorpion spiders
D. Solifuges
- 8) When do camel spiders come out to hunt for food?
A. At night
B. At noon
C. In the morning
D. During the day
- 9) What do camel spiders eat?
A. They eat plants and leaves.
B. They eat insects, rodents, and small birds.
C. They eat seeds, nuts and legumes.
D. They don't eat and live on sunlight only.
- 10) What forms the main defense for camel spiders?
A. Their speed
B. Their big jaws
C. Their venom
D. Their long legs

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "Building webs is my favorite pastime activity."
- 12) "I prefer to sit and wait for my prey rather than chasing it down."
- 13) "As a newborn baby camel spider, I wander away from mom to set up a home of my own."
- 14) "During daytime you won't find me walking around. I prefer to stay hidden and avoid the heat."
- 15) "I prefer to stay around water bodies rather than desert regions."



- 16) "After waking up at night, I go hunting for juicy insects and rodents."
- 17) "Apart from hunting, I mostly keep to myself."
- 18) "I love to roam around during the day under the hot sun."
- 19) "I absolutely love cold and polar climates."
- 20) "I'm quite dangerous to humans."
- 21) "Once I lay my eggs, I leave them alone and go my own way."
- 22) "After I lay my eggs, I carefully guard them from harm until they hatch."
- 23) "Unlike my other eight-legged relatives, I don't spin webs. I prefer to chase down my food instead."
- 24) "While some insects like damp, cool places, give me a hot desert any day of the week."
- 25) "My large jaws are not just for eating my prey, I also use them to defend myself."
- 26) "My diet is primarily composed of plants and leaves."
- 27) "I grow up and shed my skin a bunch of times before I'm all grown."
- 28) "Look at my big jaws! They take up almost one-third of my body size."

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 29) Female camel spiders lay their eggs in a burrow and protect them till they hatch.
- 30) The thought of a camel spider eating a small bird is terrifying.
- 31) Camel spiders avoid the sun and are more active at night.
- 32) Having such big jaws is what makes camel spiders so special.
- 33) Camel spiders have large jaws that make up almost a third of their body size.
- 34) Camel spiders, with their eight legs and two big jaws, look quite scary.
- 35) Unlike many other spiders, camel spiders do not spin webs.
- 36) Camel spiders can be found in desert regions around the world including the Middle East and southwestern United States.
- 37) Their hunting technique of chasing their prey is more exciting than waiting for it in a web.
- 38) Camel spiders are scarier than most other spiders.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 39) Camel spiders may eat rodents.
- 40) The camel spiderlings stay in the burrow until they are fully grown.
- 41) Camel spiders typically only hunt at night.
- 42) Camel spiders bites may be fatal to humans.
- 43) Camel spiders can be found in the Middle East.
- 44) Camel spiders come out during the day to hunt for food.
- 45) Camel spiderlings go into a cocoon and emerge fully grown.
- 46) Camel spiders capture their preys in web.
- 47) Camel spider babies shed their skin as they grow.
- 48) Camel spiders are not spiders.

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 49) Camel spiders are nocturnal creatures.
- 50) Despite their fearsome appearance, camel spiders are harmless to humans, what a relief!
- 51) Camel spiders live in deserts around the world.
- 52) Where do camel spiders live?



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- 53) What do camel spiders eat?
 - 54) The fact that a camel spider isn't actually a spider is mind-blowing!
 - 55) Camel spiders are not venomous to humans.
 - 56) Do camel spiders have venom?
 - 57) Camel spiders can run up to 10 miles per hour!



Camel Spiders

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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Camel Spiders

Name: _____

1.	B	26.	Not	51.	declarative
2.	C	27.	Would	52.	interrogative
3.	D	28.	Would	53.	interrogative
4.	C	29.	fact	54.	exclamatory
5.	C	30.	opinion	55.	declarative
6.	D	31.	fact	56.	interrogative
7.	D	32.	opinion	57.	exclamatory
8.	A	33.	fact		
9.	B	34.	opinion		
10.	B	35.	fact		
11.	Not	36.	fact		
12.	Not	37.	opinion		
13.	Would	38.	opinion		
14.	Would	39.	true		
15.	Not	40.	false		
16.	Would	41.	true		
17.	Would	42.	false		
18.	Not	43.	true		
19.	Not	44.	false		
20.	Not	45.	false		
21.	Not	46.	false		
22.	Would	47.	true		
23.	Would	48.	true		
24.	Would	49.	declarative		
25.	Would	50.	exclamatory		